

DEBORAH CHU

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EDUCATION

The University of Texas at Austin – Austin, TX

Bachelor of Arts in Government; Bachelor of Arts in Plan II Honors

May 2027

- **Minors:** Business and Public Policy; Korean
- **Certificates:** Core Texts and Ideas (Jefferson Scholars Honors Program)

Professional Education:

Google Cybersecurity Professional Certificate

Awarded May 2025

EXPERIENCE

Paragon Policy Fellowship – Austin, TX

September 2025 – Present

Technology Policy Research Intern: Collaborating with North Carolina's Office of Science, Technology, and Innovation to create a comprehensive policy report on North Carolina's critical materials and supply chain ecosystem.

Comal County Government – Comal County, TX

August 2025 – Present

Cybersecurity Policy Consultant: Revising county-wide cybersecurity policies for compliance measures and modern threat mitigation. Developing a countywide AI policy that applies to 950 employees.

CyberServe USA – Austin, TX

May 2025 – Present

Founder, Executive Director: Founded a 501(c)(3) nonprofit focused on providing basic cybersecurity and digital safety education for vulnerable populations nationwide (such as senior citizens, non-profits, legal immigrants, religious organizations, etc.). Established eight chapters in seven states with over fifty members and trained dozens of clients.

Strauss Center for International Security and Law – Austin, TX

October 2024 – Present

Cybersecurity Student Fellow: Selected for the Strauss Center's Texas Cybersecurity Clinic, which provides students with hands-on cybersecurity experience and provides pro bono services to target-rich, resource-challenged community organizations, small businesses, and public sector agencies.

UT Austin Clark Center for Australian and New Zealand Studies – Austin, TX

Spring 2025 – Present

West Scholar; Undergraduate Research Assistant: Assisting Director Rhonda Evans in International Relations policy research about the New Zealand critical minerals ecosystem and the New Zealand Supreme Court system.

Security Basecamp – Houston, TX

July 2025

Cybersecurity Analyst Intern: Creating presentations for the CEO's speaking engagements and researching threat intelligence.

OnRamps Program – Austin, TX

November 2024

Student Moderator: Participated in a series of recorded seminars about Civics and U.S. History for the UT Austin OnRamps Program, which provides college credit opportunities to high school students statewide.

UT Austin Plan II Signature Course – Austin, TX

Fall 2024

Clark Scholar; Teaching Assistant: Served as an Undergraduate TA for the "U.S., Australia, and the Rise of China" Plan II Signature Course with Dr. Rhonda Evans. The course focused on trilateral geopolitics and national security among Australia, China, and the U.S.

Office of Vivek Ramaswamy – Columbus, OH

June – July 2024

Policy Intern: Interned for Stand for Truth and OneAmerica LLCs. Conducted public policy research and authored memoranda. Created social media content, revised bibliography for Ramaswamy's *Truths* book, and prepared a brief for *The Truth Podcast*.

Love Heals Youth Non-Profit Organization – The Woodlands, TX

May – June 2024

Policy Intern: Researched the Texas foster care system to assist the CEO in formulating new policies for the Texas State Legislature innovating improvements in the foster care system; worked with local foster care youth at Days of Counseling.

ACTIVITIES

CoachUT – Austin, TX **August 2025 – Present**

Participant: Selected from applicants university-wide for a highly competitive semester-long executive coaching program.

The Cyber Directive – Austin, TX **June 2025 – Present**

Founder & Editor-in-Chief: Founded a national interdisciplinary journal focused on the intersection of cybersecurity technology, policy, and law. Currently editing first edition of the semesterly research journal.

The Texas Horn – Austin, TX **November 2024 – Present**

Staff Writer: Writing editorials for UT Austin's award-winning conservative student publication.

UT Austin School of Civic Leadership's Society of Fellows – Austin, TX **August 2024 – Present**

Fellow: Studied the intersection of political philosophy and public policy through debates and attending lectures by prominent academic, political, and social experts. Promoted civics education and civil discourse on campus.

Terrain Journal – Austin, TX **November 2023 – Present**

Head of Public Relations, Editor, Writer, Co-Founding Member: Established the *Terrain Journal* as the only undergraduate Christian academic journal at UT Austin. Spearheaded public relations initiatives and fundraised around \$2000. Won "Best Journal of the Year" for the first edition of *Terrain* at the 2025 Veritas Forum.

The University of Texas School of Law Continuing Legal Education Program – Austin, TX **October 2025**

Conference Attendee: Participated in the UT Law CLE's Essential Cybersecurity, Privacy, and AI Law Conference, focusing on emerging legal policy, compliance, and AI governance.

The Texas Orator – Austin, TX **November 2024 – September 2025**

Staff Writer: Writing editorials on cultural and political topics for UT Austin's premier multi-partisan student publication.

Hoover Institution Summer Policy Bootcamp – Palo Alto, CA **August 2025**

Policy Student: Selected as one of roughly 100 participants nationwide for an intensive, four-day program on U.S. national and international policy. Awarded "With Distinction" for policy proposal about combating ransomware with cryptocurrency regulations.

Student Government – Austin, TX **May 2024 – May 2025**

Affordability Policy Director: Served as the main advocate for UT Austin students to the university administration in matters of affordability. Worked with the UT Student Housing Union to advocate for more affordable student housing. Proposed compensation of meal plan expenses for immunocompromised students.

Student Government: Longhorn Legislative Aide Executive Agency – Austin, TX **September 2023 – May 2024**

Longhorn Legislative Aide (LLA): Assisted the Student Body Financial Director in organizing a financial literacy workshop. Raised \$800 to buy winter supplies for UT Austin's homeless population. Organized the LLA Month of Service at local food banks.

VOLUNTEERING

Plan II Honors Knowledge Is Power Program (KIPP) – Austin, TX **August 2025 – Present**

Volunteer: Providing college application assistance to juniors in under-resourced high schools.

Teach for America Ignite Fellowship – Austin, TX **May 2025 – Present**

Mathematics Academic Tutor: Providing academic mentorship to grade-school students in underserved schools.

Jefferson Scholars Program (JSP) – Austin, TX **August 2024 – May 2025**

Peer Mentor: Provided regular academic and personal mentorship for freshmen mentees.

Ignite Texas – Austin, TX **January – November 2024**

Camp Counselor: Served as Ignite summer camp counselor and Worship Team Leader for the 2024 UT Austin freshman class.

Posada Esperanza – Austin, TX **October 2024**

Volunteer: Assisted at a transitional housing program for immigrant mothers and children escaping domestic or cultural violence.